



MODULE HANDBOOK 2025/26

MSc Research Project

Module Code: COM748 (79667)

Course/s: MSc (Computer Science, AI, Internet)

School of Computing

Faculty of Computing, Engineering and the Built Environment



Mohammed Hasan

Module Coordinator

📍 Room Number

✉ Email

mhasan@qa.com; m.hasan@ulster.ac.uk

☎ Phone Number

07949012232

🕒 Office Hours

Monday-Friday 10:00 - 4:00

Notice

Please be aware the information provided within the module handbook is subject to change.

Table of Contents

Module Code: COM748 (79667)	1
Table of Contents.....	2
Welcome	3
Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and Graduate Attributes (GAs) in your module	5
Aim and Learning Outcomes	7
Assessment and Feedback.....	9
Introduction	10
Roles and Responsibilities	11
Project Selection	13
Project Preparation	14
Assessment and Viva	16
Assessment Criteria	18
Project Coordinator Contact.....	19
Reading List and Other materials.....	20
Student Voice and Support Services	32

Welcome

My name is Aftab Ali, I am a Lecturer in Computing (Internet of Things) within the School of Computing, and I am the module coordinator for: **MSc Research Project – COM748**.

Welcome to one of the most intellectually rewarding components of your postgraduate journey! We are delighted to welcome you to our community of emerging researchers, where you will embark on an exploration of independent inquiry, critical analysis, and innovation within your chosen domain of computing. In a time characterised by rapid technological advancement and interdisciplinary challenges, the ability to conduct rigorous, ethical, and impactful research has become increasingly vital. Through your engagement with this module, you will acquire the necessary skills to design, execute, and communicate a substantial research project that reflects both academic integrity and professional relevance.

Throughout this module, you can expect to:

- **Explore Cutting-Edge Topics**

You will have the opportunity to investigate a topic of your choice, whether in cyber security, IoT, digital health, AI, or another computing discipline. Your project will be grounded in current literature, emerging technologies, and real-world applications.

- **Hands-On Research Practice**

From proposal development and methodology design to data collection and analysis, this module emphasises practical research skills. You will be supported in applying theoretical frameworks to solve complex problems and generate meaningful insights.

- **Academic and Industry Insights**

We will facilitate supervisory guidance to help you refine your research direction. These interactions will provide valuable perspectives and help you align your work with both academic standards and industry expectations.

The aims of the module include supporting you in solidifying your research competencies through structured supervision, formative feedback, and access to relevant resources. You will receive guidance on ethical approval processes, technical writing, and dissemination strategies to enhance the quality and impact of your work.

The objective of the module is to empower you to become a confident and capable researcher, equipped with the analytical and communication skills necessary to contribute to your field. The experience gained during this module will serve as a foundation for future academic pursuits, professional roles, or doctoral study.

I hope you find the module intellectually stimulating and professionally enriching as you take this important step in your academic career.

Kind regards

Aftab Ali

Module Coordinator

September 2025

Module Details			
Module Title	MSc Research Project		
Module Code	COM748	Module Level	7
Credit points	60	Module Status	
Semester	1,2,3	Location	London, Birmingham and Manchester
Delivery Mode	Face-to-face		
Contact Details and Communication Methods			
Module Coordinator	 Dr Mohammed Hasan  Email: mhasan@qa.com,  Office Hours: Monday to Friday 10am - 4pm		
Teaching Staff Contact Details	All		
 General Information, Queries and Consultations	If you require advice on any aspect of the module, please read the guidance provided here, in the Module Handbook. For General Queries, please utilise the class Discussion Board. For Specific Queries or studies advice, you can avail of the 'Virtual Office Hours'. Contact any member of the teaching team by email to arrange a suitable appointment. Please note, we aim to respond to all queries within 24 hours during the working week.		
 Module Announcements	Key announcements will be presented during tutor-led activities. Out-of-class communication including notifications, reminders, etc will be distributed via the Blackboard Announcement tool. You will receive a duplication of the announcement directly to your student email inbox. It is essential that you check your emails regularly. It also advisable that you download the 'Blackboard' App as an alternative to access these announcements, notifications, and reminders as well as content.		

Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and Graduate Attributes (GAs) in your module

Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)

The UN SDGs are a comprehensive set of global goals to end poverty, protect our planet, and improve living conditions of the Global Population. This module is designed to enable you to develop the subject relevant knowledge and competencies to contribute to a sustainable future aligned with the UN SDGs.

The following Sustainable Development Goal(s) are embedded in this module of learning:

 E ☐	 E ☐	 E ☐	 E ☒	 E ☐	 E ☐
 E ☐	 E ☐	 E ☒	 E ☐	 E ☐	 E ☐
 E ☐	 E ☐	 E ☐	 E ☐	 E ☐	

KEY:

E = Embedding

Graduate Attributes (GAs)



Ulster University's Graduate Attributes are a high-level set of competencies, developing universal understandings, skills, qualities, and values.

As a result of engaging with this module you will have opportunities to develop and practise the following selected attributes:

Thriving Individual	D	A
Enhancing Potential	☒	☐
Confidence and Resilience	☐	☐
Well-being	☐	☐
Growth Mindset	☐	☐

Engaged Learner	D	A
Subject Specialist	☐	☐
Creative Problem Solver	☒	☐
Researcher	☒	☐
Critical Thinker	☒	☐

Collaborative Professional	D	A
Responsible Team Player	☐	☐
Effective Communicator	☒	☐
Enterprising Innovator	☐	☐
Digital Fluent Professional	☐	☐

Active Citizen	D	A
Citizen with Integrity	☐	☐
Inclusive Citizen	☐	☐
Sustainable Citizen	☐	☐
Future Thinker	☐	☐

KEY:

D = Developed

A = Assessed

Aim and Learning Outcomes



Module Rationale

In a world defined by rapid technological innovation and complex interdisciplinary challenges, the ability to conduct rigorous, ethical, and impactful research is a cornerstone of professional and academic excellence. Whether addressing the escalating sophistication of cyber threats, designing intelligent IoT systems, advancing digital health solutions, or developing novel AI algorithms, computing professionals are increasingly called upon to solve problems that have both technical depth and societal significance.

The MSc Research Project offers you the opportunity to undertake a sustained, independent investigation into a topic of your choice within the broad field of computing. Your work will be grounded in current literature, informed by emerging technologies, and shaped by real-world applications. This module is designed to help you integrate advanced theoretical knowledge with practical research skills, enabling you to produce outcomes that are academically robust, professionally relevant, and ethically sound.

By situating your research within its wider technical, organisational, and societal context, you will not only deepen your expertise in your chosen domain but also develop the critical awareness needed to navigate the legal, ethical, and social implications of computing innovations.

Overall Aim of the Module

This module aims to:

- Enable you to design, execute, and communicate a substantial, self-directed research project in a chosen area of computing.
- Foster a critical understanding of complex and emerging issues in your domain, from conceptualisation through to evaluation.
- Develop advanced research competencies, including methodological design, data collection, analysis, and synthesis, with a focus on producing original contributions.
- Promote awareness of the ethical, legal, and societal dimensions of computing research, ensuring that your work aligns with professional standards and responsible innovation principles.

Learning Outcomes

i What you should be able to do by the end of this module?

Successful participants will be able to:

- 1) Critically evaluate relevant technologies, frameworks, and methodologies within their chosen computing domain, including both commercial and open-source solutions.
- 2) Synthesise and apply a systematic understanding of the fundamental theories, concepts, and practices underpinning their research area, informed by a critical review of the literature.
- 3) Demonstrate insight into the management, governance, and operational considerations relevant to their domain, including scalability, sustainability, and user impact.
- 4) Analyse and appraise the legal, ethical, and social implications, such as privacy, accessibility, and responsible use, associated with the design, deployment, and evaluation of computing solutions.
- 5) Produce and defend a well-structured, evidence-based research report and oral presentation that communicates findings effectively to both specialist and non-specialist audiences.

Assessment and Feedback

i What you need to do to demonstrate achievement of learning?

Summary Assessment Information

This module will be assessed via two items of assessment

Type	Assessment method and submission date:	Percentage (%) and word count equivalent	Feedback due date
Agreed Proposal Form	Week 2-3 15th August 2026		
Project Report and Supplementary Material	Week 12 1st September 2026	50% 20%	
Submission of Slides	Week 12 4th September 2026		
Presentation and Oral Exam	Week 13 7th September 2026	30%	Within 20 working days after the submission deadline



Introduction

Who is this handbook for?

This handbook is for students taking the project module COM748, on the MSc course in Internet of Things (IoT), MSc Computer Science and MSc in Artificial Intelligence.

What's in it?

This handbook gives information and guidance on all aspects of the project module, in line with the requirements of the British Computer Society (BCS, 2022), as summarised in Appendix 1. This handbook describes how a project is allocated to you, suggests how you should tackle it, gives advice on the structure and content of the reports required, and explains how your work will be assessed.

How important is the project?

The project is very important to you as it:

- is an individual piece of work, so you can control the quality and quantity of the results produced?
- demonstrates the knowledge and skills that you have acquired on the course so far.
- demonstrates your ability to produce high quality reports.
- gives you a chance to improve/extend your knowledge and skills in a range of technical and professional areas.
- demonstrates your organisational ability, especially in planning and managing your time.
- demonstrates that you have the ability to produce a suitable computing solution to a realistic problem. This is of interest to:
 - *Future employers*, who look for signs of initiative in your work and an ability to handle all aspects of a substantial task successfully.
 - *External Examiners*, who tend to use project performance as a key indicator of overall ability.
 - *Professional Accreditation Bodies*, such as the British Computer Society, who expect a Computing degree to include a major individual

problem-solving project that is passed at the first attempt (BCS, 2022¹).

What is the project?

The research project represents a sustained intense element of study, performed by the student under suitable staff supervision. It integrates many elements of the taught modules of the course in a demanding research exemplar. Students are required to pursue a tightly constrained research challenge based on a relevant research area or industry application relating to the Internet of Things (IoT) or Artificial Intelligence (AI). However, the chosen topic will be sufficiently open-ended to allow a student to demonstrate his or her ability to engage in innovative approaches towards the achievement of a research contribution and the generation of new knowledge.

Academic Integrity

Your research project is an opportunity to demonstrate your skills, creativity, and commitment to scholarly excellence. At Ulster University, academic integrity means acting with honesty, fairness, responsibility, and respect in all academic work. This includes producing your own ideas, acknowledging the work of others through accurate citation and referencing, and resisting any temptation to gain an unfair advantage. From September 2025, the University's Regulations Governing Examinations in Programmes of Study and the Student Academic Misconduct Procedure apply to all forms of assessment, including research projects. All students are expected to familiarise themselves with, and comply with, these regulations and procedures. Your written report will be submitted through Turnitin plagiarism detection software prior to examination. Any suspected breach of academic conduct will be investigated under the University's Ordinance on Student Discipline, as approved by Council and Senate.

The Learning Enhancement provides access to a comprehensive range of [policies, protocols, and codes of practice](#), including those relating to [Academic Integrity](#). Guidance on avoiding plagiarism is available here: <https://www.plagiarismtoday.com/2022/04/28/how-to-actually-avoid-plagiarism/>.

Roles and Responsibilities

Who's in charge?

You are! You lead the project. There are several deadlines that have been set for you but the detailed plan and implementation are your responsibility. Various academic staff also give support:

- *Project Coordinator*: The Coordinator has overall management responsibility for projects. In particular, he/she arranges for staff to provide projects, organises the allocation of projects, co-ordinates assessment, and handles day-to-day issues that arise.
- *Supervisor*: Each student has a supervisor who helps guide their work on the project and contributes to its assessment. It is expected that you will meet with your

¹ British Computer Society, Academic Accreditation Guidelines, April 2022, Available online: <https://www.bcs.org/media/1209/accreditation-guidelines.pdf>. Accessed, May 2023.

supervisor regularly to review progress, discuss issues and prepare submissions for deadlines.

- *Second Marker*: A second academic member of staff is assigned to each project to mark each element independently of the supervisor.
- *Session Chair*: The project concludes with an oral examination (viva) in which you will be questioned about various aspects of your work. The oral examination will take place in a conference setting. This will be chaired by a Session chair who will moderate both your presentation and the questions which you receive.

During the project you need only communicate with the *Supervisor* and *Project Co-ordinator*. Generally, email should be used to arrange regular meetings and to sort out any queries or issues that arise.

How much time should I devote to my Project

The research project is a 60-credit point module. This is 3 times that of a usual module at MSc level (such as COM746). It is envisaged that the project will involve a total of 600 hours effort, much of which will be self-study. It is advised that you should start writing as soon as possible - it always takes much longer than you think. It is very strongly advised that you start thinking of ideas in early December and to be continuously building up a database of references for inclusion in the written report; using a reference manager such as RefWorks/ Mendeley is an efficient way of doing it and is very strongly advised. Ask your supervisor for sample reports if needed. The project will run over the following semesters depending on when you enrolled on the course September/ January and also your mode of study (Full Time/ Part time). During this time, you will be expected to work exclusively on your project.

Enrolment	Study Mode	Semester
September	Full Time	Semester 3 Year 1
September	Part Time	Semester 1&2 Year 3
January	Full Time	Semester 2 Year 2
January	Part Time	Semester 2&3 Year 3
May	Full Time	Semester 3 Year 2

How often should I see my supervisor?

You should produce a short weekly report to your supervisor summarising your project activity over that week. This provides an opportunity for your supervisor to comment on your progress or challenges encountered. Regular face-to-face meetings with your supervisor are also desirable. You should meet face to face with your supervisor at least once every 2 weeks. Commonly, these are once every week (once every 4 weeks for part-time students), but frequency will vary according to the stage of the work.

The purpose of each meeting should be made clear to your supervisor and any material for review provided a few days in advance. After each meeting, you should summarise any decisions made, or actions required, and communicate them to your supervisor. This should be documented through short informal minutes.

Project Selection

How do I select a project?

You can either propose your own topic for your project or select one from a list of proposed topics available [here](#). You will propose up to 2 topics for your initial project idea. Based on these proposals you will be assigned an academic supervisor. You will then work with your supervisor to develop these ideas into a full research proposal. A schedule **of important dates** to be aware of can be found on Blackboard under the key dates section. An example of the schedule of these dates is shown in appendix 2.

A summary of the procedure for this is provided below:

1. Identify some research areas that interest you.
2. Submit **up to** 3 potential project titles using the online form [here](#).
3. An academic supervisor will be assigned to you.
4. Arrange a meeting with your assigned supervisor.
5. Discuss your topic with your supervisor in order to assess its suitability.
6. You should then work with your supervisor to complete the project proposal form (Appendix 3).
7. This should be submitted to the project co-ordinator via blackboard.

What should my project include?

Your project must meet British Computer Society (BCS) professional requirements (BCS, 2022), which specify what computing courses need to contain, to obtain accreditation for graduates. It will be up to your Supervisor and Project Co-ordinator will assess your project proposal to ensure that it meets with the BCS guidelines for Postgraduate Projects. Specifically, projects at post graduate level must meet the following:

“Projects at postgraduate level may be similar in scope to undergraduate projects but should reflect the ethos of advanced study and scholarship appropriate to a masters degree”

Postgraduate projects must give students the opportunity to demonstrate:

- a systematic understanding of knowledge, and a critical awareness of current problems and/or new insights, much of which is at, or informed by, the forefront of the specialist academic discipline.
- a comprehensive understanding of techniques applicable to their own research or advanced scholarship.
- originality in the application of knowledge, together with a practical understanding of how established techniques of research and enquiry are used to create and interpret knowledge in the discipline.
- deal with complex issues both systematically and creatively, make sound judgements in the absence of complete data, and communicate their conclusions clearly to specialist and non-specialist audiences.
- demonstrate self-direction and originality in tackling and solving problems, and act autonomously in planning and implementing tasks at a professional or equivalent level.
- critical self-evaluation of the process

Project Preparation

Okay, I have a project, now what?

Once you have identified a project of suitable scope, you then need to provide a short-written proposal outlining the project. This should be roughly 2 pages in length, completed using the template in Appendix 3 and submitted via blackboard. This outline will not form part of the final mark, it is solely for feedback from your supervisor.

The outline should include:

- Problem statement.
- Summary of the literature and previous work.
- Hardware and software to be utilised within the project, including specialist equipment if any.
- Description of the work to be undertaken.
- Description of the data analysis tools you plan to use.
- Summary of how this would be implemented into a solution.
- Bibliography.

You should consider what you can achieve within the timeframe of the project and the outline should be concise in its description of the work that will be undertaken. If external resources such as hardware are required, you must consider if you are able to supply such items as the School will only be able to utilize the resources at its own disposal.

Will my project require ethical approval?

Ulster University requires the highest standards of professionalism in research conducted by all staff and students in all disciplines. If the proposed work raises any ethical issues, ethical approval must be sought in advance. Your supervisor advises you on the requirement of ethical approval beyond the standard category Z approval ². As part of the Project workshop series, you will be required to complete the Research Integrity training. This will be delivered online through Blackboard.

The University encourages and supports research integrity through a framework of policies, procedures and guidance, summarised and illustrated in the Code of Practice for Professional Integrity in the [Conduct of Research](#) which is updated regularly to reflect changing sector-wide requirements.

Policies/Procedures

- [Research Involving Human Participants - Policy](#)
- [Unacceptable Sources of Funding](#)

²Category Z includes projects that do not involve invasive interaction with people and does not require a full Ethical review. This includes the use of anonymous questionnaires for testing software etc.”

- [Complaints Procedure](#)
- [Data Handling Procedures/Guidance](#)

For further information on research integrity please contact the [Head of Research Governance](#). You can read the University's [annual statement on activities in support of research integrity](#).

Will I receive any additional support?

Ideas on how to tackle the project are covered in a workshop in mid-January (see Appendix 2). In particular, these will suggest how you can manage a project effectively. The first step is to organise your time and decide when you will work on the project. If you have any questions you can contact your supervisor or the Project Coordinator at any time.

Understanding & Preparation

What should I do in the initial stages of my project?

In the initial phases of your project, you should work with your assigned supervisor to identify a clear aim and associated objectives. Additionally, within this phase you should consider any ethical, Intellectual Property, or governance issues, along with any risks you may encounter. In order to assist you with this, an initial workshop will be held. Details of what will be covered during this workshop are provided in the following section. This workshop will be held midway through the Semester before you are due to start the project.

What is the purpose of the initial workshop?

A 'kick-off' workshop is used to:

- (i) Start projects early to help ensure that you have a considered perspective on your proposed project work and have time to bring it to successful completion.
- (ii) Confirm that projects are adequately defined, and a working relationship established between the student and supervisor.
- (iii) Provide general guidance on what a project entails through a consideration of the module specification, delivery schedule and support resources.
- (iv) Emphasise the importance of self-management in effective project management
- (v) Introduce the concept of the project as a form of *research-oriented problem-solving*.
- (vi) Introduce some common practices for projects in IoT and provide an overview of some tools which may be useful in the preparation and documentation of your project.
- (vii) Consider how information on the problem and solution can be gathered and documented.
- (viii) Explain the requirements for ethical approval and the process involved.
- (ix) Provide general guidance on report writing, covering the structure of the reports required, the use of the third person in describing project activity and required use of IEEE referencing in referring to external material relevant to the project.

Assessment and Viva

What should be submitted?

The Assessment consist of three parts, carried out in two submissions as follows:

- Written Assignment: Research paper (50%)
 - To include a Portfolio: Supporting Digital Material (20%)
- Presentation and Oral Examination (30%)

All components are compulsory, and students must attempt all components in order to have a mark from the module.

The student will be required to submit a report by the **dates mentioned in the Summary Assessment Information table above** and then complete a viva during the Research Conference **dates mentioned in the Summary Assessment Information table above**. Further regulations on the submission of coursework can be found in Appendix 6.

5.1 Written Report (70%)

The Written Assignment comprises of two parts.

- Research Paper (50%)
- Supporting Digital Material (20%)

Details of these are as follows:

5.1.1 Research paper (50%)

Prior to the presentation/oral examination, a Research Paper (with Turnitin similarity value) must be presented conforming to a stated specification. The research paper should be between 6 and 8 pages in length (strict limit of 8 pages), and in a format suitable for a conference submission³. Detailed information on layout and format will be made available to the students at the beginning of the project. The paper will normally be marked by two academic staff independently. 50% of the total project marks will be allocated for this research contribution. In the event of a disagreement among staff as to the merit of the work, a third member of staff, selected by the Module Coordinator, will mark the research paper.

- Abstract and Introduction (5 marks)
 - A concise statement of the contribution and context of the work.
 - The project aims, objectives and paper structure.
- Existing Work (10 marks)
 - Setting the context, literature and background review; evidence of reading in subject area, describing and summarising background coherently and in a relevant way.
- Methodology (10 marks)
 - The research approach adopted, methodology used and rationale; algorithms, hardware, design, implementation; Project risks, security

³ IEEE publishing formats:

(https://www.ieee.org/conferences_events/conferences/publishing/templates.html).

and privacy; evidence of flair, initiative, innovation; evidence of project management.

- Results (10 marks)
 - Evaluation of the results achieved. Comparison with existing work, benchmark problems etc.
- Discussion and Conclusions (10 marks)
 - Critical appraisal of results, their significance, comparative analysis, testing, etc.; indication of possible extensions.
- Presentation of Report (5 marks)
 - Quality and clarity of expression, structure, layout, conforming to guidelines, page limit, etc.

5.1.2 Supporting Material (20%)

It is recognised that an eight-page research paper may not be able to contain full details of the results achieved, methodology followed, or alternative solutions explored due to space limitations. Accordingly, the student must submit additional material (via for example, Blackboard Drop Box or One Drive), which provides supporting information to assist the reviewer if necessary. The scope of the additional material is to cover the following:

- An in-depth investigation of the context and literature to complement that within the paper (5 Marks).
- A clear description of the stages of the life cycle undertaken and tools used to support the development process (5 Marks).
- A Description of professional, ethical, social and sustainability issues within project (5 Marks).
- Critical appraisal of the project, indicating the rationale for any design/implementation decisions, lessons learnt during the course of the project, and evaluation (with hindsight) of the project outcome and the process of its production (5 Marks).

The supporting material will consist of written and visual material or more extensive results not included in the research paper. Students will be encouraged to make use of multimedia approaches with which to document these elements. Typically, the supporting material will include a written report, interactive code book and/or code repositories (maximum 2400 words) and/or short video (18 minutes maximum).

Feedback

Feedback and guidance will be provided by the Project Supervisor throughout the process. This will take place usually through verbal feedback during a face-to-face meeting. The supervisor will also, where possible, review drafts of the report. Written feedback with personalised comments relating to the work, along with an associated mark will be provided afterwards typically within two weeks.

5.2 Presentation/ Oral Examination (30%)

For each project, the Module Coordinator will set up an assessment team drawn from the academic staff, to which the student must make an oral presentation at the end of the year. This team will normally include the student's supervisor. The presentation will take the format of a conference oral presentation and is an opportunity for the student to summarise the results of the research project and respond to questions from an audience (including their peers, academic and research staff). The

presentation should be 15 mins in duration and constitutes 30% of the marks for the module. This will be followed by a question and answer session lasting approximately 10-15 minutes. A marking rubric will be available in Blackboard and the feedback of marks will be done via the Grade centre capability in Blackboard. Verbal feedback will be provided to the student following the presentation, with written feedback and associated mark breakdowns provided afterwards typically within two weeks.

Marking Guidance:

- Understanding of problem and critical evaluation of previous work (5 marks).
- Accuracy, depth and breadth of understanding (10 marks).
- Critical evaluation of the student's own work with justification of design/ methodology decisions (5 marks).
- Demonstration of implementation and testing/ validation of the solution (5 marks).
- Organisation and coherence of presentation / demonstration material (5 marks).

Assessment Criteria

The results of candidates who have successfully completed a programme of study leading to a Master's Degree shall be graded by order of merit as Pass with Distinction, Pass with Commendation and Pass. The assessment results for the final level of the programme shall determine the overall grading. The weighting of each module's contribution to the final result shall be determined by the module's credit value. Where a dissertation or project of 45 credits or more is a requirement for the award, a mark of 70% or above or 60% or above shall also be achieved in this module in order for the degree to be awarded with Distinction or Commendation respectively. Assessment rules are shown in Appendix 5.

Details of marking guidance can be found in Appendix 4. The relevant marking categories are as follows:

0-39% -Fail

At the discretion of the Board of Examiners, and by a submission date agreed by the Board, a second attempt may be made over a period of the next academic year, normally with a submission date in May. Here the student has completely failed to achieve mastery in a relevant area; the work is considered irredeemable. The project area is insufficiently understood, the results untenable, the written and/or oral presentation of the work is completely flawed, etc. The Chair of the assessment panel must summarise the panel's views in a short-written report to the Module Coordinator - which takes the form of the criticisms levelled at the work.

40-49% - Fail

This category differs from the above in that there are clear, precise, shortcomings that should be capable of being made up quickly, and relatively easily. To achieve this level an integrated understanding of relevant work is present. The text of the research paper, and the presentation, is coherent and the student has clearly absorbed the basics of what has been covered by the course during the previous year. There should be evidence of competence in practical areas reflecting the student's experience in lab sessions indicating that the student can use relevant hardware and software. However, the student fails to achieve 50% or more because there is a serious

shortcoming in the work, which prevents approval at Master's level. This could be as mundane as a critically important missing reference in the text, or a disastrous demonstration of software, for example. Other reasons might be a missing link in an argument, requiring the addition of a section in the research paper. In this case, the panel must identify precisely what needs to be done and by when. This must be agreed with the supervisor. The Chair of the assessment panel must summarise the panel's views in a short written report to the Module Co-ordinator - which lists the positive actions to be taken by the candidate, which, if completed by the candidate, could result in an award of an MSc at a subsequent Examination Board.

50-59% Pass

To achieve this level there must be significant evidence of appropriate study in relevant material and texts. There must be some evidence of placement in its wider academic and design research context. There must be a good consideration of the research issue, a proposed design solution, an implementation and an analysis of results. A consideration of the results and an awareness of the constraints and limitations of the work must be presented.

60-69% Pass with Commendation

To achieve this level there must be significant evidence of wide and deep study in relevant material and texts. This must be placed in its wider academic and design research context. There must be a solid consideration of the research issue, a proposed design solution, an implementation and an analysis of results. A balanced consideration of the results and an awareness of the constraints and limitations of the work must be presented and evident.

70-100% Pass with Distinction

The candidate is awarded an MSc. Here the candidate's work must be clearly excellent. There must be evidence of originality and creativity, indicated by novel insight. The student's contribution must be at a level which shows clear potential for doctoral research and/or published results. There must be significant demonstration of a rigorous research approach, and the achievement of challenging research results. A comprehensive grasp of methodology employed, and its positioning with respect to alternatives is necessary. The student must impress with the innovation, thoroughness and organisation of the approach.

Project Coordinator Contact

The current Project Coordinator is Dr. Mohammed Hasan who may be reached at:

Dr. Mohammed Hasan

University of Ulster – London Campus

T: +44 (0) 7949012232

E: mhasan@qa.com; m.hasan@ulster.ac.uk

Reading List and Other materials

8.1 Required Reading

- O'Leary Z., (2021), The Essential Guide to Doing Your Research Project, (Fourth Edition), London (UK), Sage Publications Ltd.
- Thomas G., (2017), How to Do Your Research Project - A Guide for Students, (Third Edition), London (UK), Sage Publication Ltd.

8.2 Recommended Reading

- D'Angelo J., (2012), Ethics in Science: Ethical Misconduct in Scientific Research (Second Edition), (UK), Boca Raton, FL, CRC Press.
- Dawson, C.W., (2015) Projects in Computing and Information Systems: a Student's Guide, 3rd Ed., Harlow (UK), Addison-Wesley.
- Gray D., (2013), Doing Research in the Real World, (Third Edition), London (UK), Sage Publications Ltd.
- Justin Zobel, Writing Justin Zobel, Writing For Computer Science, third edition, Springer, 2015.

Appendix 1: BCS Project Guidelines

The British Computer Society specifies what Computing courses need to contain to obtain accreditation for graduates (BCS, 2022).

“Project modules are considered an essential element of a degree accredited by BCS. Projects provide an ideal opportunity for students to draw together their learning throughout their degree.

Projects must include the students undertaking practical work of some sort using computing/IT technology. This is most frequently achieved by the creation of an artefact as the focus for covering all or part of an implementation lifecycle. Dissertations based solely on literature review activity and/or user/market surveys are not acceptable.

Projects must involve the production of a report which should include:

- *elucidation of the problem and the objectives of the project*
- *an in-depth investigation of the context and literature, and where appropriate, other similar products*
- *where appropriate, a clear description of the stages of the life cycle undertaken.*
- *where appropriate, a description of how verification and validation were applied at these stages.*
- *where appropriate, a description of the use of tools to support the development process.*
- *a critical appraisal of the project, indicating the rationale for any design/implementation decisions, lessons learnt during the course of the project, and evaluation (with hindsight) of the project outcome and the process of its production (including a review of the plan and any deviations from it).*
- *a description of any research hypothesis.*
- *references.*

“Projects at postgraduate level may be similar in scope to undergraduate projects but should reflect the ethos of advanced study and scholarship appropriate to a masters degree”

There are specific BCS requirements for projects at postgraduate level:

Postgraduate projects must give students the opportunity to demonstrate:

- a systematic understanding of knowledge, and a critical awareness of current problems and/or new insights, much of which is at, or informed by, the forefront of the specialist academic discipline.
- a comprehensive understanding of techniques applicable to their own research or advanced scholarship.
- originality in the application of knowledge, together with a practical understanding of how established techniques of research and enquiry are used to create and interpret knowledge in the discipline.
- deal with complex issues both systematically and creatively, make sound judgements in the absence of complete data, and communicate their conclusions clearly to specialist and non-specialist audiences.
- demonstrate self-direction and originality in tackling and solving problems, and act autonomously in planning and implementing tasks at a professional or equivalent level.
- critical self-evaluation of the process

Appendix 2: Project Schedule

The following table outlines the key dates, actions and responsibilities with respect to the project deliverables. These dates are indicative only and subject to change. For dates of actual submission please see the Key dates section on Blackboard. If you have any queries about the submission dates please speak to the project co-ordinator.

Date		Description	Responsibility
FT	PT		
Week -1	Week -1	2 outline proposal ideas	Student
Week 0	Week 0	Academic Supervisor assigned to you.	Project Coordinator
Week 1	Week 1	First meetings with Supervisor to identify suitable project.	Student
		Phase one workshop providing general project guidance	Project Coordinator
Week 2	Week 2	2-page proposal outline submitted to Project Co-Ordinator.	Student
Refer to the Summary Assessment Information table	Refer to the Summary Assessment Information table	Feedback on project proposal provided by supervisor. Supervisor to log with Ethics Panel Online.	Supervisor
Refer to the Summary Assessment Information table	Refer to the Summary Assessment Information table	Submission of written report and supporting material	Student
Refer to the Summary Assessment Information table	Refer to the Summary Assessment Information table	Submission of slides for presentation	Student
Refer to the Summary Assessment Information table	Refer to the Summary Assessment Information table	Presentation and oral examination	Student

***These are indicative dates and are subject to change. Please see blackboard for full schedule.**

0	Project Workshops
1	Submit 2 potential ideas
2	Supervisor Assigned
3	Project Proposal Submitted
4	Working on Project
5	Submission of written report and supplementary material
6	Submission of Slides
7	Presentation and oral exam

**These are indicative dates and are subject to change. Please see blackboard for full schedule.*

		Semester 1															Semester 2															Semester 3																					
Week Number		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16
Full Time Sem 1	1/2		3					4									5/6	7		0	1/2				4																										0		
Full Time Sem 2																																																					
Full Time Sem 3																																																					
Part Time Sem 1/2	1/2		3					4									4																																	0			

*Appendix 3: Project Proposal Form***COM748 Masters Research Project****Project Proposal Form**

Student Name	Student Number	Supervisor Name

Project Title

Please add a short descriptive title for the project.

Problem Statement (100 words)

Here you will set out your reasons for proposing this project. Your statement should outline the problem (what is the key issue?), indicate why you think this is worth investigating and what you hope to achieve. Treat this statement as if it were a 30 second verbal 'pitch' to convince an investor to support your product development.

Background Research (500 words)

It is expected that some preliminary research is carried out to review existing literature and previous work in the specific area that your project will target. This will help your understanding of the area of research and help formulate some ideas for the work you will carry out. You need to look for relevant books and academic papers. Google Scholar is a good starting point. You can also find out about the services offered by the [Library Ulster](#). Aim for about 5-10 key references here.

Project Aim and Objectives (300 words)

The aim is your overall intention for the project. It is the reason why you are doing the research and signals where you hope to be by the end. Your aim should be specific and phrased in such a way that it is possible to measure the outcomes as being achieved.

The objectives, and there are usually more than one, are the specific steps you will take to achieve your aim. This is where you make the project tangible by saying how you are going to go about it. Objectives are often expressed through active sentences. So, objectives often start something like "In order to achieve this aim, I will... collect, construct, produce, test, trial, measure, document, pilot, deconstruct, analyse...". Objectives are often presented as a (1) (2) (3) formatted list – this makes visible the sequence of big steps in the project. The list of objectives spells out what you actually and really will do to get to the point of it all.

Methodology/approach (400 words)

A research methodology describes the specific procedures or techniques used to identify, select, process, and analyse information about a topic. This can entail a description of research methods, approaches, and designs in detail highlighting those used throughout the study, justifying the choice through describing advantages and disadvantages of each approach and design considering their practical applicability to the research. To prepare for completion of your research paper (dissertation), in this proposal document you should highlight any particular approach, techniques, methods or tools that you have identified as being appropriate for use in your research. This should include a

description of any datasets, hardware, or software you plan to use.

Legal/ Social/ Ethical Issues (200 words)

You should Conduct and critically evaluate the project within the professional, legal, social, and ethical framework in Computer Science. For a full description of these frameworks, please consult the ACM Code of Ethics⁴ or the BCS Code of Conduct⁵ The University requires that any research that makes use of human subjects obtain ethical approval in advance. This includes techniques as simple as using a group of students to evaluate a piece of software. You should discuss ethical approval with your supervisor and together complete an online ethical approval form. Note that the Chief Investigator mentioned in the form is the Supervisor in this case. For projects that just require the use of questionnaires, using non-vulnerable adult subjects such as fellow students, there is a streamlined approval process. Your proposal should clarify that you have considered any legal/ethical/social issues that may be relevant for your project and have sought the necessary approval.

Project & Risk Management (300 words)

All projects have risks. For example, in software development there is always a significant risk that the software will not be implemented on time. It is recommended that you discuss risks with you supervisor at the outset to identify anything that might affect the success of the project and consider ways of removing or reducing such threats. This analysis should be documented. There are three main types of risk to consider:

- 1) **Health and Safety Risks:** The University requires a Health and Safety Form to be completed for all projects. Typically, computing projects will have nothing more than the standard risks related to using a computer. These are negligible. Some projects, however, may involve the use of electrical equipment or work in an environment containing hazards. All such risks should be identified, indicating how they will be mitigated.
- 2) **Management Risk:** For a computing project the most important risks are in the management needed to ensure that all work is completed on time and to a good standard. For example, if the software is created late there may be no time to test and evaluate it properly.
- 3) **Technical Risk:** These will depend on the characteristics of your project. For example, do you rely on access to a specific dataset, some piece of equipment working correctly or mastering some analysis tool?

Managing risks is a way of reducing potential problems that could affect the success of your project or the quality of what is produced.

References in IEEE format (Approx 5 References)

Include details of the referenced sources of evidence used in the preparation of your proposal and video. This should include around 5 sources of evidence. References should come from well-established forums and should be formatted according to IEEE guidelines⁶.

⁴ ACM Code of Ethics: <https://www.acm.org/code-of-ethics>

⁵ BCS Code of Conduct: <https://www.bcs.org/membership-and-registrations/become-a-member/bcs-code-of-conduct/>

⁶ <http://libraryguides.vu.edu.au/ieeereferencing/gettingstarted>

Appendix 4: Example Mark Recording Sheet

Please use this sheet to record the final marks for the three elements of the Research Project. Markers should assess the work separately and then meet to agree a mark for each element. Once complete please sign and date this sheet and return to the module co-ordinator. Please provide comments relating to all three elements of the Dissertation, including written report, presentation and additional material.

Student Name:		Student No.	
	Marker 1	Marker 2	Agreed
Final Report [50%]			
Supporting Material [20%]			
Presentation [30%]			
Total Mark			
Marker 1 Comments			
Marker 2 Comments			
	Signature	Date	
Marker 1 Signature			
Marker 2 Signature			

Research Paper

Criteria	Distinction	Commendation	Pass	Fail	Low Fail
Mark Band	70-100%	60-69%	50-59%	40-49%	0-39%
Abstract (5 Marks)	Exceptionally well written Abstract providing an outstanding overview of the work undertaken and clearly outlining the contribution in a concise manner. extremely well related to broader context; scope accurately delimited and justified; aims very clear; outline of treatment of data excellent.	Excellently written abstract outlining the work undertaken to excellent of detail. Outline of contribution very good well related to broader context; scope carefully delimited and/or justified; aims clear; outline of treatment of data very good.	Well written abstract. Provided in sufficient level of detail. This was not concise. Contribution outline was good/ reasonable related to broader context; delimitation/justification present but lacking rigour; aims reasonable; outline of treatment of data good/reasonable	not well related to broader context; area defined but without convincing justification or rigour; aims perhaps unclear or not well stated; outline of treatment of data reasonable but possibly of doubtful appropriateness	Poorly written abstract which does not describe the work undertaken in sufficient detail. No contribution stated or very unclear. Unrelated or badly related to the broader context; area ill-defined; aims unclear, unrealistic, or badly stated; outline of treatment of data muddled/in-appropriate/absent
Existing Work (10 Marks)	excellent literature review has made an extensive search and has accurately depicted the field; scholarly attention to detail and showing originality/initiative; ties in very well with defined problem	Good review of literature; evidence of extensive search of literature and has depicted the field with some accuracy but perhaps missed some dimensions; good attention to detail; ties in well with defined problem	Evidence of reading supplementary sources. Reasonable review of literature; has made a very reasonable but perhaps uninspired depiction of field with some missing dimensions; reasonable attention to detail; originality not particularly evident; ties in reasonably with the defined problem	Minimal Evidence of Reading. poor review of literature or poor depiction of the field with noticeable omissions; poor attention to detail; lacks originality or shows few signs of initiative; does not tie in well with the defined problem.	Little or no evidence of reading. literature sources inappropriate/misused or missing; hardly related at all to the field; hardly any attention to detail; lacks originality and work shows very little initiative; does not really tie in with the defined problem
Methodology (10 Marks)	appropriate methods selected and justified; expertly handled; exceptional understanding of implications/limitations. very good understanding of data collected; analysed and used data very well	appropriate methods selected and justified; wide knowledge of techniques; Wide understanding of implications /limitations. good understanding of data collection, preparation, and cleaning; analysed and used data well	appropriate methods selected and justified although some weakness; reasonable handling of techniques; reasonable understanding of implications/limitations. reasonable understanding of data collection, preparation, and cleaning with perhaps some error or minor confusion in analysis and use of the data	Methods only just appropriate; weak justification; poor handling of techniques; poor/hardly any understanding of implications/limitations. little understanding of data collection, preparation and cleaning with errors or confusion in analysis and use of data	Methods inappropriate / misunderstood/misused; poor handling giving rise to serious doubts about validity of process and products; poor/no understanding of implications /limitations. poor understanding of data collection, preparation and cleaning with serious errors/confusion in analysis and use of data perhaps hardly analysed/used at all
Results (10 Marks)	results very clearly presented and related well to the defined problem showing really good integration of this work with the broader field.	results clearly presented and quite well related to the defined problem showing good, but not outstanding, relevance of this work to the broader field	results mostly clear and reasonably well related to the defined problem; results reasonably relevant to the broader field	results often unclear/poorly presented; shows some relationship to the defined problem but perhaps patchy; results only marginally relevant to the broader field	results mostly unclear/badly presented; badly related or unrelated to the defined problem; little/no relevance to the broader field
Discussion and Conclusions (10 Marks)	logically derived and fully supported by foregoing evidence; well-organised; evidence of initiative/originality; good awareness of future avenues for investigation and research proposals for such; awareness of the limitations of the project and methods employed	logically derived but less evidence of initiative/originality; simple awareness of needs for further investigation; some awareness of limitations of project and methods of employed	logically derived but less evidence of initiative/originality; simple awareness of needs for further investigation; some awareness of future needs and/or limitations of project and methods employed	not fully logical, some conclusions/recommendations omitted; insight into value of the work not demonstrated; no awareness of future research needs	based on uncertain evidence; frequently illogical; conclusions and/or recommendations omitted or little evidence of organisation in conclusions; no/mistaken views about what the work shows
References and Presentation (5 Marks)	Outstanding quality and clarity of expression. Paper well formatted in keeping with guidelines. Paper excellently structured. Outstanding use of referencing from highly reputable sources	Excellently formatted in keeping with guidelines. Good structure and clearly expressed ideas and concepts. Comprehensive use of referencing though scope for more/ higher quality articles to be included	Paper generally well formatted/ structure, though room for improvement. References adequate, generally of good quality and used appropriately with room for improvement.	Paper is poorly structured or in keeping with format. Refencing inadequate. Small number of references used, however these are of poor quality or not relevant.	Paper is inadequately structured and not keeping with formatting guidelines. Referencing inadequate. Poor use of references, incomplete, missing or from poor quality sources.

Supplementary Material						
Criteria	Distinction		Commendation	Pass	Fail	Low Fail
Mark Band	70-100%		60-69%	50-59%	40-49%	0-39%
An in-depth investigation of the literature (5 Marks).	Excellent literature building on that within the research paper to provide a more rounded and comprehensive view of the problem. Demonstration of in depth reading of the problem area.	Good additional review of the literature provided. Though perhaps could be a little more comprehensive to show broad understanding of the area.	Some additional review of the literature provided; however, this is limited or not well focused.	Some limited discussion of the literature which does not advance that found within the written report.	No additional review of the literature provided.	
Description of the stages of the life cycle undertaken (5 Marks).	Excellent description of all aspects of the software development, risk management and project management process undertaken.	Good discussion of the software development, risk management and project management undertaken, room for more detail on some aspects.	Good discussion of the software development, risk management and project management undertaken, perhaps missing some key elements.	Limited discussion of the stages of the development cycle, risk management and project management. Perhaps impacting on the overall completion of the project.	None/ very limited discussion of the project lifecycle and management.	
Description of professional, ethical, social and sustainability issues within project (5 Marks).	Comprehensive process put in place to evaluate the professional, economic, social, environmental, moral and ethical issues involved in the sustainable exploitation of computer technology and be guided by the adoption of appropriate professional, ethical and legal practices. This is explained in an excellent level of detail.	Good description of the professional, economic, social, environmental, moral and ethical issues involved in the sustainable exploitation of computer technology and be guided by the adoption of appropriate professional, ethical and legal practices. Mostly comprehensive but perhaps lacking some detail.	Good description of the professional, economic, social, environmental, moral and ethical issues involved in the sustainable exploitation of computer technology and be guided by the adoption of appropriate professional, ethical and legal practices. Perhaps some aspects not explained clearly or complete.	A very limited attempt to describe/ the professional, economic, social, environmental, moral and ethical issues involved in the sustainable exploitation of computer technology and be guided by the adoption of appropriate professional, ethical and legal practices. This is perhaps not well followed or implemented.	No discussion of the professional, economic, social, environmental, moral and ethical issues involved in the sustainable exploitation of computer technology and be guided by the adoption of appropriate professional, ethical and legal practices within the project.	
Critical appraisal of the project (5 Marks)	All weaknesses in the research are indicated and weighed relative to each other. Furthermore, (better) alternatives for the methods used are indicated.	Most weaknesses in the research are indicated and impacts on the main results are weighed relative to each other.	Most weaknesses in the research are indicated but impacts on the main results are not weighed relative to each other.	Only some possible weaknesses and/or weaknesses which are in reality irrelevant or non-existent have been identified.	No discussion and/or reflection on the research. Discussion only touches trivial or very general points of criticism.	

Presentation						
Criteria	Distinction		Commendation	Pass	Fail	Low Fail
Mark Band	70-100%		60-69%	50-59%	40-49%	0-39%
Understanding of problem and critical evaluation of previous work (5 Marks).	Fully explains background and information gap for project Articulates compelling study rationale Clarifies study significance in an exceptional manner. Exhibits superior knowledge of key concepts in subject area. Exhibits excellent depth of knowledge in subject area. Arguments are exceptionally coherent, clear, and organized to identify a gap in the literature. Targets the identified gap(s) in the literature and explains them very well.	Is able to evaluate critically a range of literature relating to current research and advanced scholarship in the discipline. Makes consistently good use of appropriate academic conventions and academic honesty.	Provides background for project Adequately articulates study rationale. Clarifies study significance. Exhibits adequate knowledge of key concepts in subject area. Exhibits depth of knowledge in subject area. Arguments are coherent, clear, and organized to identify a gap in the literature. Targets the identified gap(s) in the literature.	Fails to adequately provide background. Fails to articulate study rationale well. Does not articulate study significance. Exhibits poor knowledge of key concepts in subject area. Exhibits poor depth of knowledge in subject area. Some arguments are not coherent, clear, or well organized to identify a gap in the literature Fails to target the identified gap(s) in the literature	Fails to evidence or discuss/apply appropriate examples of literature relating to current research and advanced scholarship in the field. References to literature/ evidence and use of academic conventions are flawed/irrelevant.	
Accuracy, depth and breadth of understanding (10 Marks).	Produces work of exceptional standard, reflecting excellent understanding. Displays mastery of a complex and specialised area of knowledge and skills, with notable critical awareness of current problems and/or new insights at forefront of field. Offers new insights during discussion, in-depth argumentation, leading to a very interesting scientific meeting, detailed argumentation for all questions. Articulates methods in detail and explains them very well.	Demonstrates a systematic knowledge, understanding and critical awareness of current problems and/or new insights, much of which is at, or informed by, the forefront of the academic discipline, field of study or area of professional practice. Deals with advanced questions efficiently and comfortably, interacts well with questioners, detailed argumentation for most questions, interesting scientific meeting	Demonstrates a sound knowledge and understanding of material within a specialised field. Is able to deal with part of the advanced questions, rarely depends on supervisor, provides detailed argumentation only for a limited set of questions. Articulates methods.	Demonstrates knowledge of the field and awareness of current evidence and issues, but with some notable weaknesses. Lacks knowledge and understanding of some key areas. Is able to deal with basic questions, depends on supervisor for advanced questions, is able to provide basic arguments, absence of detailed argumentation. Fails to articulate methods.	Demonstrates little knowledge of the field. Demonstrates significant weaknesses in the knowledge base, and/or simply reproduces knowledge without evidence of understanding. Major gaps in Knowledge and understanding. Significant inaccuracies. Is hardly able to deal with the most basic questions, is hardly able to provide basic arguments.	
Critical evaluation of the student's own work with justification of design/ methodology decisions (5 Marks).	Shows excellent ability to evaluate methodologies critically and, where appropriate, to propose new hypotheses. Deals with complex issues systematically and creatively, making excellent judgements.	Is able to evaluate methodologies critically and, where appropriate, to propose new hypotheses. Is able to deal with complex issues both systematically and creatively, making sound judgements in the absence of complete data.	Demonstrates an understanding of current theoretical and methodological approaches and how these affect the way the knowledge base is interpreted. Provides evidence of relevant and sound analysis within the specialised area, with some critical evaluation. Able to analyse complex issues and make appropriate judgements.	Offers some appropriate analysis, but with some significant inconsistencies which affect the soundness of argument and/or conclusions. Demonstrates very limited critical ability. Lacks sufficient understanding of how established techniques of research and enquiry are used to create and interpret knowledge.	Shows little or no critical ability. Poor, inconsistent analysis. Lacks any understanding of how established techniques of research and enquiry are used to create and interpret knowledge.	
Demonstration of implementation and testing/ validation of the solution (5 Marks).	Excellent demonstration of solution. With detailed discussion of testing/ validation methodology or framework with little to no weakness.	Good demonstration of solution. With some discussion of testing/ validation methodology or framework. Perhaps room for further testing.	Satisfactory demonstration of solution. With limited discussion of testing/ validation methodology or framework. Substantial room for further testing/ validation.	Limited demonstration of solution. With little to no discussion of testing/ validation methodology or framework. Discussion of testing or validation is substantially lacking.	No demonstration of solution. With no discussion of testing or validation.	
Organisation and coherence of presentation / demonstration material (5 Marks).	Excellent overall presentation; substantial level of analysis clearly presented; evidence of independent enquiry or creativity; wide knowledge of the project area	Well structured; clear presentation; some analysis clearly presented; some evidence of independent enquiry or creativity; good knowledge of the project area	Substantially correct; basic understanding of relevant principles; adequate technical content; adequate presentation.	Some technical content; incomplete understanding of relevant principles; somewhat lacking in presentation.	Little or no technical content; major failures in presentation; major conceptual misunderstandings.	

Appendix 5- Regulation of Standards

Assessment rules

Pass mark for modules is 50%

Classification for the Final Result for Master's Degrees:

- Pass with Distinction 70%
- Pass with Commendation 60%
- Pass 50%

The Board of Examiners shall recommend the award of a Pass with Distinction to a candidate who achieves an overall average of 70% or more in the taught modules, with a mark of at least 70% being achieved in the IoT Master's Project module.

The Board of Examiners shall recommend the award of a Pass with Commendation to a candidate who achieves an overall average of 60% or more in the taught modules, with a mark of at least 60% being achieved in the IoT Master's Project module.

Classification for the Final Result for Postgraduate Diploma:

- Pass with Distinction 70%
- Pass with Commendation 60%
- Pass 50%

The Board of Examiners shall recommend the award of a Pass with Distinction to a candidate who achieves an overall average of 70% or more in the taught modules.

The Board of Examiners shall recommend the award of a Pass with Commendation to a candidate who achieves an overall average of 60% or more in the taught modules.

Appendix 6- Submission of Coursework

Coursework shall be submitted by the dates specified by the Course Committee.

Students may seek prior consent from the Course Committee to submit coursework after the official deadline; such requests must be accompanied by a satisfactory explanation, accompanied in the case of illness by a medical certificate. This application shall be made to the Course Director.

Coursework submitted without consent after the deadline shall not normally be accepted.

Candidates completing a dissertation shall submit a project outline for approval in accordance with the Guidelines for the [Preparation of Dissertations for Master's Degree Programmes](#). The dissertation shall be submitted by the date specified in the IoT Masters Project Research module specification. The dissertation shall be presented in accordance with the Guidelines for the Presentation of Dissertations for Master's Degree programme [as above]. One soft-bound copy and one electronic copy of the dissertation shall be submitted by specified date for assessment.

Dissertations which achieve a final mark of 70% or above shall be deposited in digital form in the University Library. Access to such dissertations shall not normally be restricted. Access may be restricted, in exceptional circumstances, for a period of up to two years in the first instance, and for a total period of not more than five years. Such restriction shall be approved in accordance with the procedures described in the Guidelines for the Presentation of Dissertations for Master's Degree programmes. Access to the abstract of the work shall not be restricted. A statement regarding access shall be included in the introduction to dissertations deposited in the Library in accordance with the Guidelines.

Student Voice and Support Services

How we support you



As a course team, we incorporate the key partnership principles set out in the joint Ulster University Students' services' [Student Voice](#) and proactively engage to ensure that student opinion is heard at QAHE. We respect your views and welcome your honest and constructive feedback.

You can contact your Module Coordinator about any queries related to your learning experiences on the module as/when you have them.

You can voice your opinions through the formal Staff/Student Consultative Committee process by contacting one of the elected student representative. You will have the opportunity to give feedback on the module through completing the online Student Module Feedback Survey.

UU Student Wellbeing Service

Ulster University's Student Wellbeing team is available to help you manage common pressures many students experience while studying in higher education. Common pressures include stress, relationship issues, financial problems, and managing disability-related challenges, including mental health difficulties. There is no stigma to seeking support to maximise your wellbeing and achievement at UU.

Student Wellbeing support is free and confidential and is located on each of our campuses. Please view the Student Wellbeing pages for details on how to [contact student wellbeing](#) staff.

UU Student Success Team

Ulster University's Student Success team has developed a series of academic and study skills training resources and workshops to help you succeed educationally and develop personally and professionally. You can access these resources on campus in contacting the ACE team or access resources via the [ACE Team website](#) or you can contact the team directly via [London](#), [Birmingham](#).

Career service

Career Consultants offer you career guidance face-to-face and virtually. These flexible appointments can take place throughout the day or in the evenings and are designed to fit around your studies. Each appointment is completely bespoke, to suit your needs and the sector you are interested in.

Appointments can cover the following:

- Career planning
- CV writing
- Cover letter and application reviews
- Mock interviews
- Enterprise activities
- Psychometric test practices

Career Development Resources

Unlimited access to our online Careers Portal, [QA Higher Education Careers Online](#), full of helpful resources including employer videos and practice psychometric tests.

We also put together a weekly newsletter, highlighting current job opportunities as well as on-campus workshops and events in your local area. Find out more about networking opportunities and employed-led events, alongside upcoming recruitment simulations, to help you prepare for assessment centres.

You can reach us on [Student Careers](#).